



Fisheries and Oceans
Canada

Pêches et Océans
Canada

Fisheries and Oceans Canada (DFO) Instructions

ELOG – Logbook – Lobster

National (Quebec, Gulf, Maritimes and
Newfoundland and Labrador Regions)

Version 234.7

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This document is provided to users of the Electronic Logbook (ELOG). It provides details of the information requested by Fisheries and Oceans Canada (DFO) in electronic logbooks. The information contained in this document has no legal value and is made available for the sole purpose of helping users to complete the ELOG correctly.

ELOG Key

In your software, be sure to enter the ELOG Key exactly as it is written on the DFO web site. An incorrect ELOG key will prevent you from successfully transmitting your logbooks to DFO.

DFO Client Support Agents can assist with ELOG related issues and can be reached at 1-877-535-7307 from Monday to Friday from 08:00 to 21:00 (Atlantic Time) excluding holidays. Additional up to date information on the ELOG Key is available at www.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/elogs.

DFO Client Support

If you have submitted your ELOG to DFO and find that you have made a mistake, please contact DFO Client Support at 1-877-535-7307 to request corrections to the information submitted. Telephone support is available Monday to Friday from 08:00 to 21:00 (Atlantic Time), except on statutory holidays.

Please refer to your licence conditions for additional instructions to be followed in situations where a fish harvester cannot properly transmit their ELOG data.

ELOG Application Supplier Client Support

The ELOG Application Supplier should be contacted for assistance with any of the following type of issues:

- I don't know where to put the ELOG Key into my application.
- I am having trouble copy/pasting my ELOG key into my ELOG application.
- How do I use my ELOG application?
- My application is not working/I don't understand my application.
- I can't install or log-in to my ELOG application.
- I can't open/close a trip.
- The GPS on my device is not working (get in touch with the ELOG Application Supplier, for instructions on how to manually enter coordinates).
- Any troubleshooting needs, such as any error messages that appear in the application.

ELOG Application Supplier information will be listed on DFO's website at: www.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/qualified/index.htm.

Software or Hardware Issues

In situations where the software or equipment used to complete the ELOG is non-functional, such as lost, stolen, defective or stolen telephones, tablets or computers, please refer to your licence conditions for details on the information to be provided in such situations, the procedures to be followed and the deadlines to be met.

Closure of Sections Within the ELOG

The application allows for the individual closure of various sections of the logbook. The closure of the sections implies that you have verified that the information entered is consistent with what you want to declare. The closure of a section means that you will no longer be able to modify the information in that section from your software. Your licence conditions may require that you close a section of your logbook at a specific time that is different from the complete closure of your electronic logbook.

If the information in a closed section prevents you from continuing to complete your logbook, you will need to contact your application supplier to make the necessary corrections.

If the information in a closed section is incorrect and does not prevent you from completing your logbook, please submit your logbook to DFO as is and contact DFO to request that corrections be made to your submitted logbook. Please note that corrections made by DFO will not be reflected in your application. If you would like the correction to be made in your application as well, you will need to contact your application supplier. However, the application supplier will need to obtain approval from DFO before making modifications to your information.

Fisher Identification Number (FIN), Licence Number and Vessel Registration Number (VRN)

In your software, be sure to enter the appropriate Fisher Identification Number (FIN), Vessel Registration Number (VRN) or Vessel Identification Number (VIN) (the VIN applies to Gulf region fish harvesters only) and licence number exactly as they appear on the fishing licence you are using or licence conditions. Missing or inaccurate data can cause issues with your information once received by DFO.

The instructions below detail the information required for submission into the application based on the context of your specific fishery:

- If you are the fishing licence holder:
 - Indicate your FIN;
 - Indicate your licence number
 - Indicate the VRN of the fishing vessel used to carry out your fishing activities;
- If you are fishing under a licence held by an Indigenous Community or Organization:
 - Indicate the FIN of the Indigenous Community or Organization;
 - Indicate the licence number used to carry out the fishing activity, i.e. the licence number of the Indigenous Community or Organization for which you are acting as the designated operator;
 - Indicate the VRN of the fishing vessel used to carry out your fishing activities;
 - Your name, as the designated operator on the licence, must be entered into the “Operator’s name” field of your ELOG.
- If you are fishing under a licence held by a company:
 - Indicate the FIN of the company;
 - Indicate the licence number of the company;
 - Indicate the VRN of the fishing vessel used to carry out your fishing activities;

- Your name must be entered into the “Operator’s name” field of your ELOG.
- If you are acting as a substitute operator:
 - Indicate the FIN of the licence holder you are replacing;
 - Indicate the licence number of the licence holder you are replacing or for whom you are acting as operator;
 - Your name, as the current operator and licence operator, must be entered in the "Operator’s name" field of the ELOG. **Note:** For Newfoundland and Labrador, you must also include the Operator’s FIN in this field, alongside the Operator’s name
- If you are fishing under a partnership agreement (buddy-up):
 - Be sure to indicate the following in the fields provided;
 - The VRN of the fishing vessel used to carry out your fishing activities;
 - The FIN attached to the authorized fishing vessel; The licence number attached to the authorized fishing vessel;
 - The FIN attached to the authorized fishing vessel; The licence number attached to the authorized fishing vessel; Indicate the name of both operators, separated by a semicolon, in the “Operator’s name” field of the ELOG. **Note:** For Newfoundland and Labrador indicate the FIN and the license number of the license holder being fished

Simultaneous Fishery

For Quebec, Maritimes and Newfoundland and Labrador fish harvesters, if you are fishing under two licences simultaneously during the same fishing trip, you must complete two separate ELOGs, ensuring that you complete all mandatory fields in each of the sections of both of the ELOGs.

For Gulf fish harvesters, in the case of an Indigenous Community or Organization fishing multiple licences simultaneously, all required elements of the “Fishing Effort” section must be completed for each licence under which the effort is being conducted. If fishing under more than one licence number on the same vessel, during the same trip, the Fishing Effort section of the ELOG must be filled in at least once for each licence.

Substitute Vessel

If you are using a Substitute Vessel, you must enter the VRN or VIN of the vessel you are currently using to complete the fishing activity and landing.

GPS Position and Coordinates

Your software may have a function that automatically reads your position from your GPS. If your actual position does not match the position requested in the E-log, enter the requested geographical coordinates manually.

Comments

Enter any additional information that you may consider important in this field.

Maps

If there are regional fishing area maps associated with ELOGS they will be found here <http://www.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fisheries-peches/sdc-cps/nir-nei/elog-maps-cartes-jbe-eng.html> . This does not represent a full list of fishing area maps. This catalogue will be updated as new or amended maps become available. If the fishing area described in your license conditions is not included below please contact your local DFO office. For all other questions, please contact DFO at the following email: fishing-peche@dfo-mpo.gc.ca

General Logbook Instructions, by Section (All regions)

General Information

DFO administrative region	Indicate your DFO Administrative region in which you are licensed.
Licence holder's Fisher Identification Number (FIN)	Indicate the Fisher Identification Number (FIN) of the licence holder as it appears on the fishing licence or conditions of licence.
Vessel Registration Number (VRN) or Vessel Identification Number (VIN for Gulf)	Indicate the Vessel Registration Number (VRN) or Vessel Identification Number (VIN) of the fishing vessel used to carry out your fishing activities. The VIN applies to Gulf region fish harvesters only.

Fishing Trip Section

Trip number	This information is generally generated automatically by the software.
Operator's Name	When there is more than one operator, list each name on the same line and separate each one using semicolons. Newfoundland & Labrador: If you are a designated operator, include both the operator's name and FIN in this field.
Date/time of start of the fishing trip	Indicate the date and time at the beginning of the fishing trip (when the vessel leaves the port).
Unique identifier of the electronic logbook (Logbook UID)	This information is generated automatically by the software.
Number of crew members	Quebec and Gulf: Indicate the number of crew members including the captain but excluding the observers at sea Others: Not applicable
Port	Quebec, and Newfoundland & Labrador: Indicate the name of the port of departure. Others: Not applicable
Is this vessel using a carrier?	Quebec: Indicate Yes if you will use a different vessel to land the lobsters. Otherwise, indicate No.

	Others: Not applicable
Partnership indicator	Quebec: When fishing under a partnership agreement, select “Buddy-up”, otherwise, select “None”.
	Others: Not applicable
At-Sea Observer trip number	Maritimes: If an at-sea observer is on board during fishing activities, enter the trip number of the at-sea observer.
	Others: Not applicable

Bait Used Section

Bait type	Indicate the type of bait used.
Weight	Indicate the weight of bait used.
Bait condition	Quebec, Gulf and Maritimes: Indicate the condition of the bait used (frozen, fresh or salted).
	Others: Not applicable

Species at Risk Section

The information related to Species at Risk (SAR) must be completed for each interaction with a SAR or each group of individuals of the same SAR. When reporting an interaction with a species at risk, you must report the number of individuals and, optionally, the estimated total weight of the species at risk.

Date/time	Indicate the date and time of the interaction with the species at risk.
Latitude	Indicate the latitude where the interaction with the species at risk occurred.
Longitude	Indicate the longitude where the interaction with the species at risk occurred.
Species	Identify the species at risk involved.
Number of specimens	Indicate the number of specimens involved.
Total weight estimated	Indicate the total estimated weight of species at risk involved.
Condition of specimens	Indicate the condition (dead, alive, etc.) of the specimens involved, after the interaction.

Hail out Section

Hail out company	Maritimes: Identify the company that issued the hail out confirmation number (only required for certain areas)
	Others: not applicable.
Hail out confirmation number	Maritimes: Indicate the hail out confirmation number (only required for certain areas)

	Others: not applicable.
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Hail in Section

Hail in company	Maritimes: Identify the company that issued the hail in confirmation number (required only for certain areas). Others: not applicable.
Hail in confirmation number	Maritimes: Indicate the hail in confirmation number (required only for certain areas). Others: not applicable.
Estimated date and time of arrival	Maritimes: Indicate the expected date and time of arrival at wharf (required only for certain areas). Others: not applicable.
Total weight onboard	Maritimes: Indicate the total weight of lobster on board at the time of the call (required only for certain areas). Others: not applicable.

Personal Consumption/Use Section

All catches that were kept on-board the vessel and that will not be sold to a registered buyer must be declared as personal consumption/use. In Maritimes and Gulf regions, this includes catches transferred in a pond or to another vessel.

Species	Indicate the species declared as personal consumption/use.
Product form	Only the product form "Round" may be selected.
Size	Gulf : Indicate the size of the product. Others: Not applicable
Kept weight	Indicate the estimated kept weight in whole form of the species kept as personal consumption/use. After you have landed, if the retained weight differs from the weight previously entered, you must contact Fisheries and Oceans Canada at 1-877-535-7307 from Monday to Friday between 07:00 and 20:00 (Eastern Time Zone) to request a correction to your data.
Foreseen usage	Maritimes: Indicate the expected use of this fish kept for personal usage. Others: Not applicable

Fishing Effort Section – Effort

Date/time at start	Indicate the date and time at the beginning of the fishing effort. Note: Indicate the date and time when fishing activities begin (when gear is set or fishing physically starts), <u>not</u> the time of the start of the trip when the vessel leaves the port.
Date/time at end	Indicate the date and time at the end of the fishing effort. Note: This refers to when fishing activities have ended (e.g., when all gear has been fully retrieved for that trip), and before the vessel begins sailing back to port.
Licence number	Indicate the licence number used to fish during this fishing effort. Please refer to the Fisher Identification Number (FIN), Licence Number and Vessel Registration Number (VRN) section on page 3 and 4 for more details on accurate use of substitute operator, partnership agreement and fishing under a licence held by an Indigenous Community or Organization.
Fishery Management Area	Indicate the fishery management area (Lobster Fishing Area, LFA) where fishing occurred. Note: Fishery Management Areas may be known as Species Management Areas in Newfoundland and Labrador.
Interaction with a species at risk during this fishing effort?	Indicate (yes or no) if an interaction with a species at risk occurred during this fishing effort.

Fishing Effort Section – Targeted Species

Species	Indicate the species you are attempting to catch (targeting) under valid licence conditions during this fishing effort.
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Fishing Effort Section – Fishing Gear Used

Fishing gear	Indicate the type of fishing gear used during this fishing effort.
Details about gear	Newfoundland and Labrador: Indicate the material the traps are made of. Others: Not applicable

Fishing Effort Section – Effort Detail

When reporting your catch, you must report the species and quantities separately for each group of traps. In Quebec and Gulf, each group of traps reported separately must have the same soaking time as well.

In Newfoundland and Labrador, each group of traps/pots reported separately must have the same soaking time and trap size.

Gears' group Number	The gears' group number is a sequential number assigned to the gear set with the same soaked duration. Newfoundland and Labrador: This is also identified by trap/pot size.
Trap/Pot size	Newfoundland and Labrador: Indicate the size of the traps/pots of this group of traps/pots. Others: Not applicable
Number of gear hauled	Indicate the number of traps/pots hauled in this group of traps/pots.
Soaked duration	Quebec, Gulf and Newfoundland and Labrador: Indicate the soaked duration of the group of traps/pots. Others: Not applicable
Latitude	Quebec, Gulf and Maritimes: Indicate the latitude at the end of the fishing activity (when the last gear was hauled). Others: Not applicable
Longitude	Quebec, Gulf and Maritimes: Indicate the longitude at the end of the fishing activity (when the last gear was hauled). Others: Not applicable
Grid (end)	Quebec: Indicate the grid where you were at the end of the fishing activity (the position of the fishing site - letters and numbers). Others: Not applicable
Lobster catch and settlement grid	Maritimes: Indicate the grid where you were at the end of the fishing activity (when the last gear was hauled).. Others: Not applicable
Statistical section	Newfoundland and Labrador: Indicate the statistical section in which this group of traps was hauled. Others: Not applicable
Number of lobsters already V-notched	Quebec: Indicate the number of lobsters you caught that were already V-notched. (required only for certain areas).

	Others: Not applicable
Number of lobsters you V-notched	Newfoundland & Labrador and Quebec: Indicate the number of lobsters you V-notched. This information is only requested in certain fishing areas.
	Others: Not applicable

Fishing Effort Section – Catches

In Quebec and Newfoundland and Labrador, report the quantities of each species caught, whether they have been discarded at sea or retained on board the vessel for landing. Refer to your licence conditions to find out what you must report.

In Gulf, you must declare the estimated weight of lobster, rock crab, cunner and sculpin kept onboard the vessel that will eventually be sold or kept for personal use (including used as bait).

Catches of species at risk must only be reported in the Species at Risk section.

In Quebec, Maritimes and Newfoundland and Labrador, if at the end of the hauling of this group of traps, no lobster or catches of any species have been caught, then you must report a weight of 0 lb (or kg) of lobster caught. In Gulf, you must report a weight of 0 lb (or kg) if no lobster is kept.

In Quebec and Newfoundland and Labrador, you must report your bycatches in the catch section of the ELOG, even if you used some of it as bait during your fishing trip.

Species	Indicate the species caught.
Kept weight	Indicate the estimated weight of the species kept on-board the vessel to be sold or kept as personal consumption. Quebec: This also includes the species kept on-board to be transferred in a pond or to another vessel. Quebec, Maritimes and Newfoundland and Labrador: This weight must not include the weight of the specimens discarded at sea and must always be evaluated according to the whole form. Gulf: You must report your bycatches within the total estimate in lb or kg in the ELOG, even if you have used some of it for bait during your fishing trip.
Number of specimens kept	Newfoundland and Labrador: Indicate the number of individuals identified in the field "Species" that you kept onboard to be sold or kept as personal consumption. This number must not include the number of individuals discarded at sea. Others: Not applicable

Number of specimens discarded	Quebec and Newfoundland & Labrador: Indicate the number of specimens identified in the field "Species" that you discarded at sea. Others: Not applicable
Number of females berried	Maritimes: Indicate the number of females caught in this group of traps that were berried (required only for certain areas). Others: Not applicable
Product form	Indicate the form of the product. Only the product form "Round" may be selected.

Landing Section

Transport Vessel Registration Number (VRN)	Quebec: If another vessel has been (or will be) used to land the fish, indicate the Vessel Registration Number (VRN) of this vessel. Others: Not applicable
Date/time of landing	Indicate the date and time (estimated) of the beginning of the landing (Offloading of catch).
Landing port	Indicate the name of the landing port. This refers to the port where the landing has occurred or will take place.

Transfer Section

Date/time of the transfer	Quebec: Indicate the date and time at the beginning of the transfer of catches to a pond or onto another boat. Others: not applicable.
VRN (source)	Quebec: Indicate the Vessel Registration Number (VRN) of the vessel from which the transfer of the catches occurred. Others: not applicable.
Vessel name (source)	Quebec: Indicate the vessel name of the vessel from which the transfer of the catches occurred. Others: not applicable.
Pond (source)	Quebec: Indicate the number of the pond from which the transfer of the catches occurred. Others: not applicable.
VRN (destination)	Quebec: Indicate the Vessel Registration Number (VRN) of the vessel to which the catches are transferred.

	Others: not applicable.
Vessel name (destination)	Quebec: Indicate the vessel name of the vessel to which the catches are transferred.
	Others: not applicable.
Pond (destination)	Quebec: Indicate the number of the pond to which the catches are transferred.
	Others: not applicable.

Transfer Section – Detail of the Transfer

Species	Quebec: Indicate the species transferred.
	Others: not applicable.
Product form	Quebec: Indicate the form of the product. Only the product form “Round” may be selected.
	Others: not applicable.
Weight	Quebec: This weight must always be evaluated according to the round form.
	Others: not applicable.